In Praise of Gaṇeśvara

Gaṇeśvarastava · Toh 1175 · Derge Tengyur
ཚོགས་ཀྱི་དབང་ཕྱུག་གི་བསྟོད་པ

In Praise of Gaṇeśvara, known in Sanskrit as the Gaṇeśvarastava and in Tibetan as Tsokkyi Wangchuk gi Töpa, is a short hymn in eight verses to Gaṇeśvara, the elephant-faced "Lord of the Hosts," better known as Gaṇeśa or Gaṇapati, who in Buddhist tantric practice is honored as a lord of obstacles and a giver of wealth and accomplishment. Its verses praise his tusked elephant face, his jeweled body and swaying anklets, his blazing weapons and his victory over obstructors and Māra, and they cast him in Buddhist terms, his feet embodying the two truths, conventional and ultimate, before a closing dedication prays that beings may pass beyond all obstacles to the sameness of the ultimate. It was composed by the fifteenth-century Indian master Vanaratna, who gave it as a gift from a monastery in the city of Patan in Nepal to a Tibetan monk, who then translated it into Tibetan as a teaching to be shared with others. It is Toh 1175 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the section of praises (stotra).

In the language of India: gaṇeśvarsyastavaḥ
In the language of Tibet: In Praise of Gaṇeśvara.

Homage to Gaṇeśvara (Gaṇeśa).

King of the great hosts, who brings about victory,
With the face of a lord of elephants, baring his tusks,
Lovely of countenance, bearing the characteristics of the supreme person:
To the lord of the hosts, the supreme king, I pay homage.

His body adorned with the finest jewels of divine substance,
His two feet, full and rounded, with anklets swaying,
Are at once the supreme truths, conventional and ultimate:
To the supreme of hosts, the lord of kings, I pay homage.

With sublime purity he enters the battle against what must be overcome;
Victorious in battle, he holds blazing weapons in his hands;
His supreme feet are the diadem of the lords of the earth:
To the supreme king, the lord of the hosts, I pay homage.

With hands and feet like the finest lotuses
That send forth radiance through all the boundless reaches, leaving nothing out,

With stainless eyes shaped like the finest bow:
To the king, the supreme lord of the hosts, I pay homage.

The supreme noble one, source of good qualities, bearer of renown,
Grown mightier than the might of the lords of the earth,
By the strength of his arm surely victorious over obstructors, as over Māra:
To the lord, the supreme of hosts, the king, I pay homage.

He satisfies people with treasures and with precious flavors,
And, as the supreme taste of the great nectar abounds,
He is supreme in forbearance toward those worn down by dread of the terrors of existence:
To the lord of kings, the supreme of the hosts, I pay homage.

His defining characteristic is bliss, well won through diligence;
He is the supreme truth, devoted to words of the happiness
That fulfills the wishes of sentient beings:
To the supreme of hosts, the lord and king, I pay homage.

By the virtue fully gained through the fire of praise
To the holy Lord of Obstructors, made by Vanaratna,
Through his granting of the far shore, where obstructors are exhausted and existence is conquered,
May beings come to sameness, in the way of the ultimate.

The text called In Praise of Gaṇeśvara, composed by the master Śrī Vanaratnapāda, is complete.

That same great paṇḍita, a lord who had attained accomplishment, bestowed it as a gift from the monastery of Śrī Govicandra in the great city of Yerang (Patan) in the glorious land of Nepal, so that through his kindness the supreme accomplishment might be brought forth. The monk and yoga practitioner (yogācāra) called Gyatsö Dé received it upon the crown of his head, and with unshakable devotion and boundless joy of mind he held it in the cupped hands of great good fortune and made it his sacred commitment. He translated it into the Tibetan language at the great temple of Flourishing Jewels and made it a Dharma to be given to others as well. By this, may every wish, worldly and beyond the world, be fulfilled for myself and others.

Translator's Notes

- In the first verse the text's gang chen is read as glang chen, "elephant", which the image of the tusked face requires. The "fire of praise" in the closing verse is kept as written; it seems to play on the author's name Vanaratna, "jewel of the forest", and on the fire that consumes obstacles. The temple where the translation was made, "Flourishing Jewels" (nor bu rgyas pa), is not identified, so its name is translated by meaning.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.